

TIM 80C, Lecture # 3 (4/7/26)

Agenda

0 : Complete Product dissection
done : see above

1. HW # 1, Prob. 1 : SPSP

2. HW # 2, Prob. 2 : Product Dissection

Comments :

1) Scope of the course : lower division, specifically aimed at 1st, 2nd year students in any Major

2) Your homework :

- all text needs to be type-written ; not handwritten
- diagrams can be hand-drawn & inserted in the text

1. HW # 1, Prob. # 1

Raw problem statement: "Improve the home computer."

Use the structured problem solving process (SPSP):
customize the SPSP template on Canvas for this problem.

Step 1: Define the real problem.

Assess existing home computers with respect to the user needs, & then develop guidelines & recommendations for improving the home-computer w.r.t. each of these needs.

Step 2: Create a plan

(1) What are the different types of home-computers, & which type am I going to focus on for this problem

- laptop, desktop, server
- Dell, Apple, Lenovo, ...

⇒ focus on the computer type I'm familiar with.

- (2) what are the typical user needs for home computers?
- (3) what are the key sub-systems of a home computer?
(Create a FAST diagram that relates user needs (sub-functions) to sub-systems.)
- (4) Assess how well existing home computers satisfy user (or customer) needs.
- (5) Create a table with guidelines & recommendations for improving home computers
(research, structured brainstorming)

Step 3 : Execute the plan

Rewrite each step of the above plan,
and then for each step show the execution
or implementation

.. .. } execution

⇒ Results

Table (of Results) :

Customer needs (Step 2)	Assessment (Step 4)	Recommendations for improvement (Step 5)
Price		
Performance - speed - memory - ?		
Reliability - - - -		

SPSP Step 4 : Check your work

- Are my results reasonable to me?
- Test your results on others

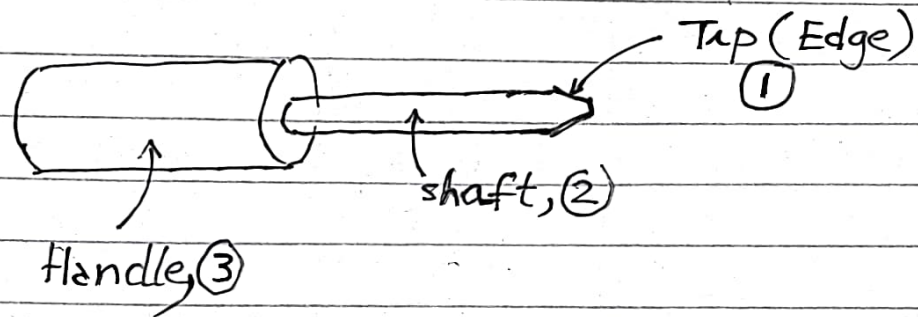
SPSP Step 5 : Learn ("Reflection")

- Learn & generalize from your results on the actual problem solved : draw conclusions
- your own problem-solving style.

2.

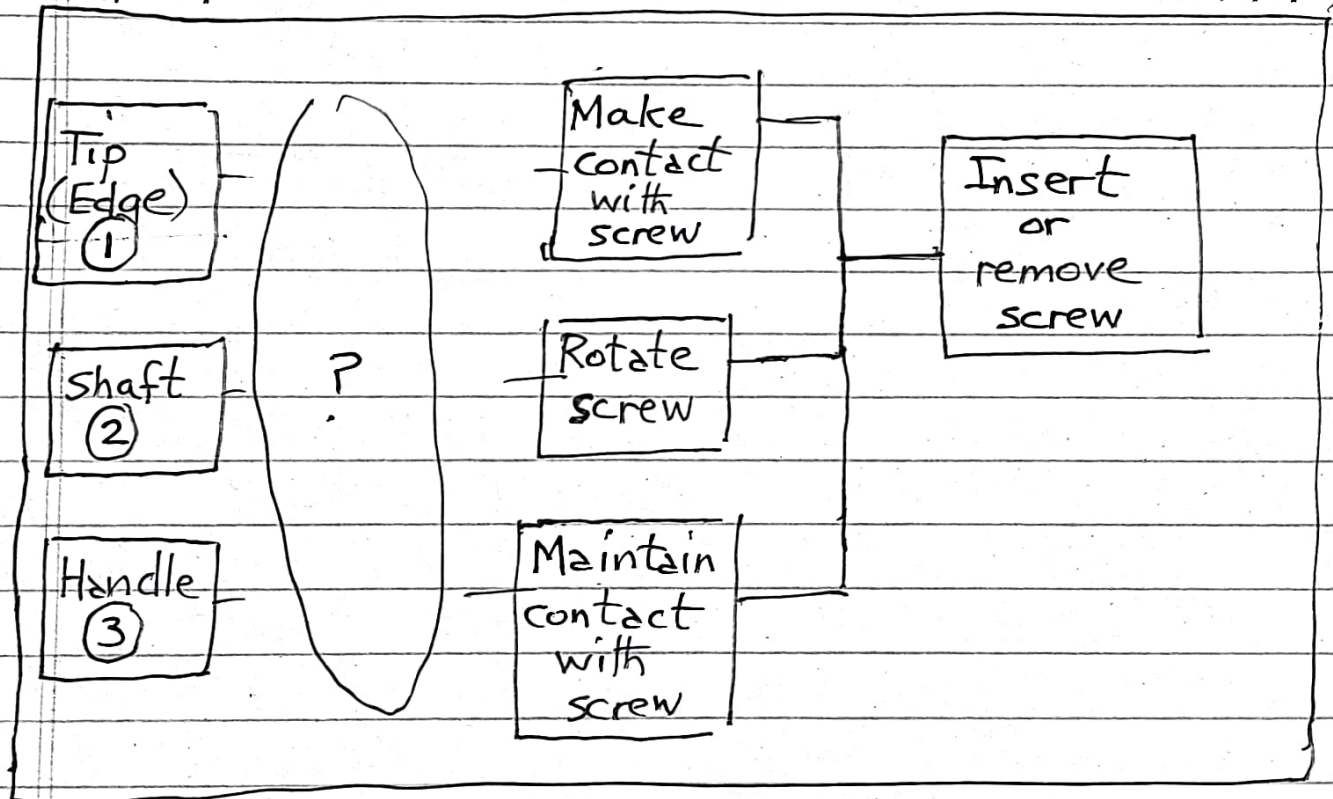
HW #1, Prob. 2 : Dissecting different products using FAST

Screwdriver :



← HOW ?

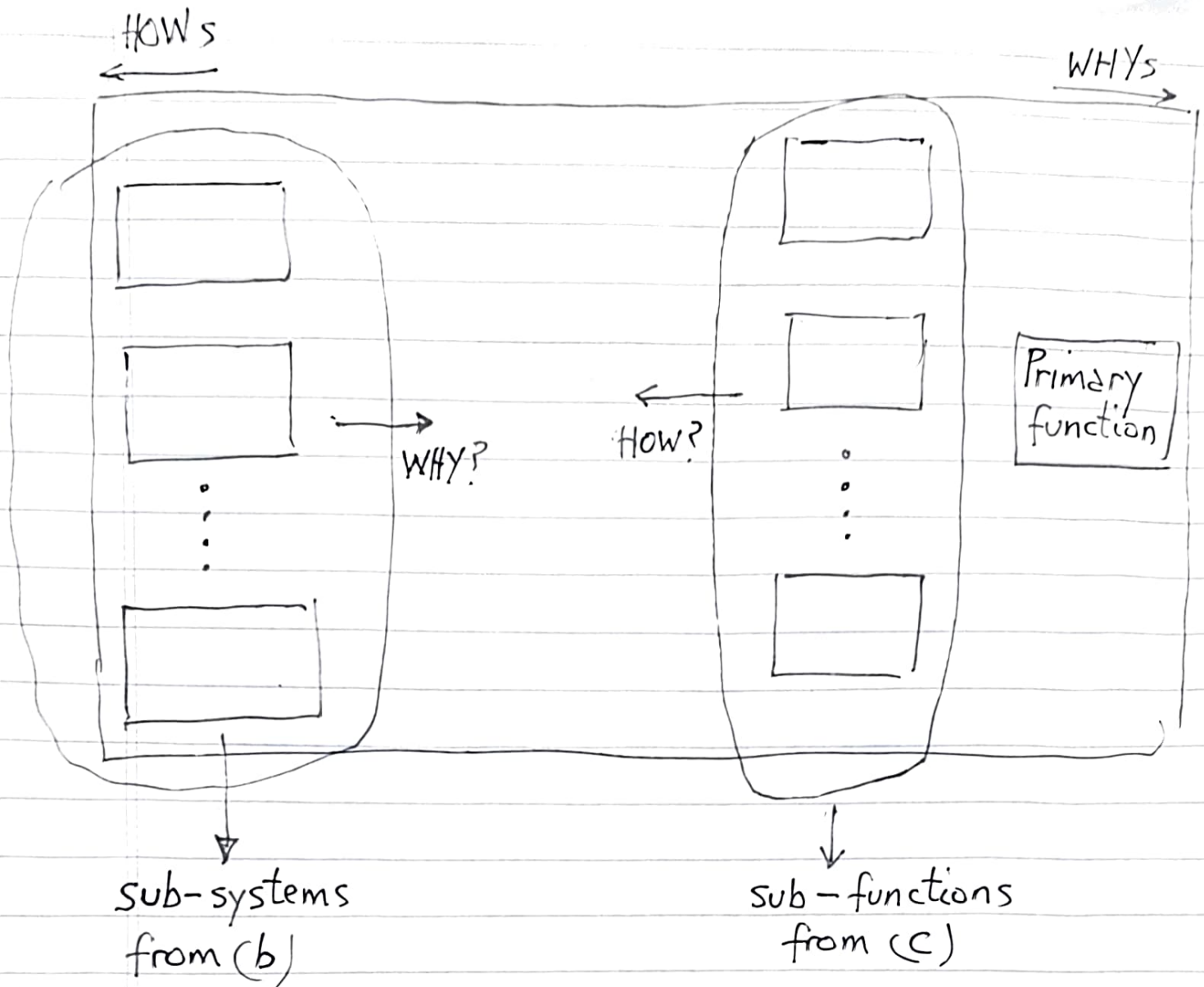
→ WHY ?



Function Analysis System Technique (FAST) or Reverse Engineering or Product Dissection of complex products (e.g., bicycle)

- (a) Understand how the product works -
(for example, howstuffworks.com)
- (b) Make a list of the key sub-systems
of the product.
- (c) Identify the main function (or purpose)
of the product, and make a list of the
sub-functions of the product.
- (d) Work from both ends of the FAST
diagram:





Observation : This is an iterative, trial & error process $\Rightarrow$ should converge in 2-3 iterations.

HW # 1, Prob. 2

Bicycle:

- understand how the bicycle works
⇒ make notes

Key sub-systems:

- Transmission
- Brakes
- Chassis (frame)
- Steering mechanism
- wheels
- pedals
- ...
- ...

What are the key sub-functions

Primary function: Transport person from A to B

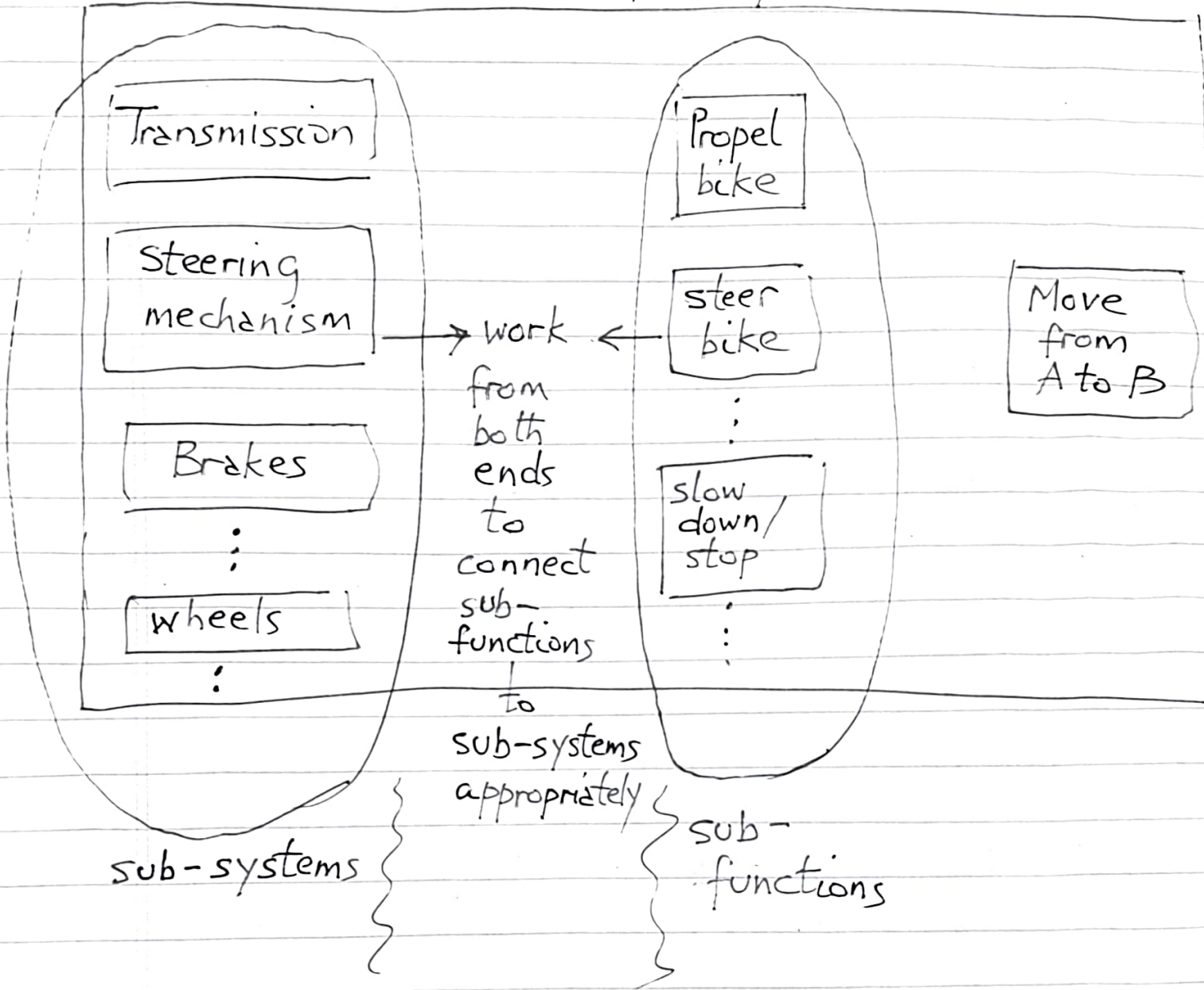
Sub-functions:

- Propel or move
- steer
- slow down/stop
- ...
- ...

HOWs
←

FAST for bicycle

WHYs
→



Laptop

Understand how the laptop works $\Rightarrow$ make notes

Make a list of the key sub-systems

- | | |
|------------------------|-----------|
| - Microprocessor (CPU) | - Screen |
| - Operating System | - Storage |
| - Keyboard | - Battery |
| - Trackpad (Mouse) | - ... |
| | - ... |

Make a list of the key sub-functions